and Kashmir would have to accede to either India or Pakistan, as it would have great difficulty protecting its security on its own.[11]

Ismay's Treachery

What did 'Pug' Ismay do? Ismay, fluent in both Urdu and Punjabi, is reported to have conferred with the Maharaja in Punjabi and with Kak in Urdu. His conversations are not a part of the official record. What did he discuss with Kak and the Maharaja respectively? Did Mountbatten get independent intelligence feedback about these vernacular discussions? We can safely infer that not only did Ismay meet Col. Bacon in Srinagar, but he also met Maj. Gen. Scott, Chief of Staff of the Jammu and Kashmir state forces. It is obvious that the issue of the state forces manning the Gilgit Agency would have come up in these conversations since the lease was likely to be rescinded before the transfer of power on 15 August 1947. In that event, who would be the Political Agent? Would the Gilgit Scouts accept a non-British officer? Maybe a Muslim one, but certainly not a Hindu officer. Where would Maj. Gen. Scott source such an officer from?

Sensing some skulduggery afoot, on his return to Delhi, Mountbatten announced that the Gilgit lease would be rescinded on 31 July 1947. This set the proverbial cat amongst the pigeons as far as Ismay was concerned. Col. Bacon immediately summoned Maj. Brown who was then stationed in Waziristan as a major with the Tochi Scouts.[12] In Waziristan, Brown had sounded out Capt. Jock Mathieson and primed him to become his deputy in Gilgit if and when the eventuality arose. During the first week of July 1947, Maj. Brown met Col. Bacon, who had convinced Maj. Gen. Scott and the Maharaja to appoint British officers as Commandant and Deputy Commandant of the Gilgit Scouts until a more 'suitable' arrangement was arranged. Both of these officers would report to the Kashmir state-appointed Political Agent or Governor. The selected officers were to be Brown and Mathieson.[13]